

Chapter 79-2

//

When Xu Qingzhu returned to Shallow Water Bay, Liang Shi was standing at the entrance in a daze.

Only when she saw her car driving in did Liang Shi slowly raise her hand and wave. She didn't look like she was in a good mood.

Now she finally understood what Liang Shi meant by "about to explode."

It was rare to see such an expression on Liang Shi's face—a bit restless, her hair casually tied into a low ponytail, left to blow in the wind.

"You're back," Liang Shi said. "Go pack your things."

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Then wait for me a bit."

"Do you have a lot of things?" Liang Shi asked.

"Not much," Xu Qingzhu said. "Just some clothes."

Liang Shi followed behind Xu Qingzhu upstairs. She didn't go inside, just stood at the top of the stairs, but she didn't look at the living room at all.

Xu Qingzhu couldn't help but ask, "Teacher Liang, do you have germaphobia?"

Liang Shi was still in a daze and hadn't snapped out of it. "Huh?"

Then she shook her head, but then nodded again. "A little bit."

"Then why are you so anxious right now?" Xu Qingzhu asked. "Is it purely because those people came into the house?"

"Yes," Liang Shi said. "I just feel like this place could have people coming in at any time. It doesn't feel safe at all."

So it was a lack of security.

Xu Qingzhu acknowledged with an "oh" and packed her things even faster.

Neither of them had many belongings—two suitcases and some miscellaneous items.

Then they left that night and went to a hotel.

The suite that Liang Shi had spent a fortune on was on a high floor. After entering, one could overlook the entire city—the intricate transportation network, the bustling traffic, the bright lights. It looked absolutely beautiful.

It was enough to lift one's spirits.

Liang Shi sat on the hotel sofa, her restlessness finally soothed.

She took a big gulp of water. Her two long legs were crossed on the sofa. After relaxing, she looked toward Xu Qingzhu, who was standing by the window admiring the view, and finally remembered to ask about what had happened that evening.

"How did your discussion go?" Liang Shi asked. "Did it work out?"

"Mm." Xu Qingzhu turned her head and smiled. "Very smoothly."

"Are we going directly to the new place tomorrow?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi nodded. "Yes. I won't go to the company tomorrow morning. Let's move first."

The shock she had received today was too great. She needed time to recover.

This behavior actually surprised Xu Qingzhu greatly. She had thought Liang Shi would choose to drop off their things in the morning and then go to work.

Facing Xu Qingzhu's astonished gaze, Liang Shi explained, "I already submitted my resignation letter today, so tomorrow is my last day of work. It should be... fine."

She paused for a moment, then shrugged. "It doesn't matter anymore."

"I thought you would stick it out until your last day at work," Xu Qingzhu said. "But this is nice too. You can get some good rest."

"That's not it." Liang Shi looked at her, her brow furrowing again, and said gently, "I need time."

"What do you mean?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

"I don't know if you understand, but when I came back, there was a group of people standing in the living room. They might have even gone into my room, my bathroom, my washroom." As Liang Shi spoke, her voice was strained, with an almost imperceptible tremor. "It's just... just..."

After stumbling twice, Liang Shi finally let out a heavy breath. "I feel like their shadows are everywhere in that house. So I can't go to work in this state. It would affect others."

Xu Qingzhu's expression froze. She slowly walked over to the sofa, approaching Liang Shi, but didn't say anything.

She was standing while Liang Shi was sitting—a looking-down angle. Liang Shi was wearing a loose crew-neck sweatshirt in a lotus root white color that complemented her skin tone beautifully.

The light made her dyed brown hair gleam. A thin layer of sweat had seeped out on the tip of her nose, and the tip of her nose was a bit red, which didn't quite match the rest of her complexion.

But... it was rather cute.

Cute?

When this word appeared in Xu Qingzhu's mind, it startled her.

How... could one use "cute" to describe an Alpha?

But... she really was cute.

Xu Qingzhu wavered on the scale between reason and emotion, and before long, she chose emotion.

Liang Shi was usually so easy-going—no matter what you wanted to do, she would say okay, okay, okay. As long as you had a problem, she would help you solve it.

She clearly hadn't been by her side for very long, yet she gave people the illusion that "you can completely rely on me because I'm very strong."

Someone like that seemed impervious to harm, without any weaknesses.

She had never seen such an expression on her face before, so this little bit of restlessness seemed precious, and also cute and charming.

Liang Shi was still stumbling through her thoughts, trying to figure out how to describe her somewhat neurotic state, when she suddenly noticed that Xu Qingzhu was standing right beside her, looking at her with a... very complicated expression.

Her gaze held indulgence and tolerance, and also a hint of mischief... there was even something indescribable in it.

Liang Shi: "?"

"Teacher Xu." Liang Shi was startled and instinctively shrank back, then showed a helpless expression after being startled. "What are you doing?"

She sounded a bit aggrieved.

Xu Qingzhu said, "Getting closer to you so I can hear more clearly."

"I can't really explain it." Liang Shi shook her head. "This is beyond my ability to put into words. Anyway, it's just... really annoying and disgusting."

She took a deep breath and adjusted her emotions. "Alright, don't worry about me. Go wash up and sleep. You must be tired after being busy all day."

"Why shouldn't I worry about you?" Xu Qingzhu sat down beside her, her tone casual. "You haven't finished talking yet."

"I've finished," Liang Shi said. "That's all there is."

"What about the story behind it?" Xu Qingzhu asked, turning to look at her. "It's impossible to have this kind of psychological response for no reason. Have you encountered this kind of situation before?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She was silent for two seconds, then asked, "Teacher Xu, have you ever considered becoming a psychologist?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"I have over ten years of experience with psychological counseling," Xu Qingzhu said. "You could say illness makes a good doctor.¹ You can understand it that way if you want."

Liang Shi: "..."

After two moments of speechlessness, Liang Shi said helplessly, "It's nothing major. It's all in the past. Go rest."

Liang Shi kept urging her, but Xu Qingzhu wouldn't leave. She even grabbed Liang Shi's hand when Liang Shi reached out to push her away.

Her fingertips caressed Liang Shi's wrist, pressing right on her pulse point. She said in a low voice, "I want to hear about these little things."

Liang Shi suddenly paused.

Those cool fingers pressed on her pulse, gently pressing down, making even her tailbone go numb.

Liang Shi swallowed instinctively, and all the words she was about to say were swallowed back down.

The lights in this hotel living room weren't very bright—a dim yellow color. The two of them were already sitting close together. Now, with their eyes meeting, Liang Shi could clearly see Xu Qingzhu's features.

Her lips were the color of honey peach pink, glistening with a watery gleam. The tip of her nose was pert, her nose bridge straight. The space between her eyes was just right. Her dark pupils gazed at her with exceptional tenderness, as if her entire heart was placed on you.

1. "久病成醫" (jiǔ bìng chéng yī) is a Chinese proverb meaning "long illness makes a doctor" - the idea that someone who has been ill for a long time gains medical knowledge through their experience. Xu Qingzhu is implying that her extensive experience as a patient in psychological counseling has given her insight into psychology. ⇐